Travel Policy

Adopted March 5, 2025

1. General Policy - All authorized travel expenses incurred by a member of the department or the board while conducting PVFD or PVSSD business outside a 50 mile radius of the administrative office shall be paid by PVFD.
2. Pre-Approval - Approval from the Fire Chief is required prior to incurring travel-related expenses.
3. Documentation - After travel expenses have been incurred, the member must submit a Travel Reimbursement Form which details the reason for the trip and the specific travel expenses. Travel Reimbursement Forms must be signed by the member and approved by the Fire Chief.
4. Travel-related expenses include:

    a. Costs to travel to and from the business destination.
    b. Transportation costs while at the business destination.
    c. Lodging, meals, and incidental expenses.

5. Transportation

    a. PVFD Vehicles – PVFD vehicles may be used for travel associated with official business.
    b. Personal Vehicle Use - A member who uses his or her personal vehicle for PVFD business will be reimbursed for mileage in accordance with the IRS current mileage reimbursement rules. In 2025, the amount is 70 cents per mile.
    c. Alternative Travel Arrangements - Members may structure alternative travel and lodging to reduce costs or to accommodate personal preferences if the alternatives provide a documented cost savings to PVFD or the member pays the increased costs. If a member chooses to drive rather than fly for out-of-state travel, PVFD will reimburse the member based on the least expensive method of travel, rather than actual mileage.
    d. Rental Cars - Members may obtain a rental car with prior approval or in cases of documented need. Groups of members at the same location shall share rental vehicles where practical. When a rental car is used, rental agency liability and collision/loss damage coverage is required, at PVFD expense.

6. Travel Related Meals

    a. Meal Per Diems - Members shall be paid for meals (including tax, tips, and other meal related expenses) at the per diem rate established by the State of Utah (Utah Administrative Code R25-7), including all rules contained therein. In 2025, the rate is $68 per day. Per diem may be paid to members prior to leaving for the travel destination.
    b. Direct charge on members personal credit card – Members may use personal credit cards to pay for approved travel related meals. Members must retain all receipts related to such purchases and submit them with the Travel Reimbursement Form. In the event that the daily total expense for meals is greater than the allowable per diem amount, the member will only be reimbursed up to the allowable per diem amount.

7. Incidental Expenses - Incidental expenses are not considered part of a meal per diem reimbursement and, therefore, receipts are required. Incidental expenses include ground transportation, parking, and related tips; fax, telephone, internet, or copy charges; and other business related expenses. Other tips are not reimbursable.

8. Lodging - Travel that requires an overnight stay must pre-approved by the Fire Chief. PVFD will pay for lodging up to $110 per night with applicable taxes. Detailed receipts are required to be submitted to the Fire Chief in order to claim refunds for taxes paid.
9. Personal Expenses - Personal expenses, including entertainment or alcohol, are the responsibility of the member and will not be reimbursed by PVFD.
10. Member expenses paid by other entities – PVFD members that provide services to other entities either formally or informally may represent the interest of those entities as well as PVFD while traveling on official PVFD business. Where possible, the shared benefit of the member activities while traveling should be determined and costs of that travel proportionally split between the benefiting entities.

    If any member travel-related expenses are paid directly by another entity, those payments must be documented and disclosed to PVFD. Any travel-related expenses that are paid by another entity must not be submitted to PVFD for reimbursement to the member. In such circumstances PVFD will reimburse the members for travel related costs and then bill the other entity the proportional share of those travel-related costs, or the other entity will bill PVFD for its proportional share of the travel-related costs paid by the other entity. Expenses paid by another entity are also governed by the Ethics and Conflict of Interest Policy.

    11. In the event that a member receives a per diem allowance prior to traveling and is not able to travel, the member will return those funds to PVFD. If upon review of travel expenses inappropriate or fraudulent expenses have been incurred the member may be subject to disciplinary action including; recovery of funds, inability to travel, suspension or termination of the members association with the PVFD.